



Finance Planning
Mortgage Network

Knowledge Hub

December 2025



Welcome to the Finance Planning monthly round-up newsletter for November 2025,

We are finally into the last month of what we hope has been an exciting and prosperous year for you all. As ever quite a few challenges have had to be faced from all sides but its testament to all your hard work that our network has faced those challenges with much success. Our attention now turns to building a pipeline for 2026 with our January conference also on the horizon with much planned to give you some ideas, support and inspiration to set you up well for the year.

From all at The Finance Planning Group we wish you and your families a happy and healthy Christmas and New Year

Thank you.

David



Compliance News 19/25 (Record Keeping)

We provided a reminder of the need to record interest only sales properly in your Suitability Reports, plus a refresher of the importance of using our suggested paragraphs to help justify your protection sales.

CPD Reminder

By the end of this month we should all have completed, and recorded, at least 16 hours of Mortgage CPD, plus 16 hours of Protection CPD. We will soon be auditing your CPD Logs and so please do ensure that your Logs are up-to-date by the end of the year – thank you.

Annual Competency Re-validation Workshops

Our annual knowledge updates, and testing, will be happening again very soon. We are hoping to have our webinars ready to watch before the Christmas break, meaning you can either complete this annual assessment in late December, or in early January.

Aviva

Please try to avoid using this insurer for the time being because they have extremely long delays in underwriting applications. They currently have a 39 working day backlog for assessing medical information.

Some Recent Industry Complaints investigated by FOS

Mr and Mrs L had initially gone through a broker for their mortgage; however, due to the property being a new build, the offer was extended twice. Therefore, the original 5-year term was reduced and the product end date did not change – something they stated the broker did not inform them of.

Decision: **Upheld**. Brokers must be vigilant when extending offers, to ensure customers are aware if the fixed deal end date has changed or remains the same.

Mr and Mrs H received advice from a broker regarding an ERC on their current mortgage. The adviser told them to apply with another lender as the ERC was minimal. However, upon completion, the ERC was thousands of pounds more than anticipated.

Decision: **Upheld**. Advisers must be careful when providing advice around current ERCs on client products. To ensure advice around a customer's ERCs are correct, it would be best to speak to the client's lender if possible.

Mr D obtained a mortgage in principle with a broker that did not reserve a rate. The broker was advised the rate would increase in the next 7 days; however, the client had not had his offer accepted on the property until the day the rate increased, nor did he pay the product fee upfront. The client believed the adviser was at fault for not securing the rate.

Decision: **Not Upheld**. The rate was not secured as the client did not pay the product fee upfront nor submit a full application. By the time the client was ready to proceed with an accepted offer, it was too late to apply for that rate. Advisers need to discuss potential outcomes for such scenarios with clients, so they understand the risk if rates are to change during the process.



Good news story...

Earlier this year, one of our long-serving advisers clients Sarah and Mark faced an overwhelming shock when Sarah was diagnosed with cancer. Amid the whirlwind of appointments and uncertainty, one thing they didn't have to worry about was their home. Their Critical Illness cover with Guardian paid out swiftly and in full, allowing them to clear their entire mortgage in one go. For Sarah and Mark, the relief was immense — the financial pressure lifted instantly, giving them the space to focus on Sarah's treatment, recovery, and time together as a family. Their experience is a powerful reminder of just how crucial the right protection can be when life changes without warning.

NOVEMBER PROTECTION WORKSHOPS RE-CAP:

Matt has been hard at work this month appearing on the AMI Viewpoint Panel Debate and hosting 3 amazing Protection Workshops with Steve Orton. Please see the links below to view the workshops on the Knowledge Hub and if you'd like to see "Studio Matt" then please click on the AMI link to see the Viewpoint Report session (Matt appears at the 9:59 mark).

Session 1 – 7th November – 2pm – **Unlocking Sales Behaviours That Drive Results**
(<https://knowledgehub.website/7-11-2025-winter-workshop-1-unlocking-sales-behaviours-that-drive-results/>)

Session 2 – 14th November – 2pm – **Income Protection: The Conversation That Pays**
(<https://knowledgehub.website/winter-workshop-2-exposing-the-realities-that-make-income-protection/>)

Session 3 – 21st November – 2pm – **Building Certainty With Trusts and Wills**
(<https://knowledgehub.website/winter-workshop-3-unlocking-the-power-of-trusts-and-wills-in-client-conversations/>)

AMI Viewpoint 2025: <https://www.a-m-i.org.uk/protectionviewpoint/>



In this mortgage update we are minimising the number of product or specific criteria changes as you can review these from the vast array of emails you receive from lenders each day.

Lloyds Banking Group

From 5th January 2026 Halifax, Bm Solutions and Scottish Widows will be making changes to their procurement fee arrangements, if you have any questions please don't hesitate to contact your sales manager. Here are the new terms

Halifax Procurement Fee Terms for Legal & General Mortgage Club	
The below proc fee structures will take effect from 5 th January 2026. For existing pipeline cases the previous proc fee commission structures may still apply, this will depend on when the illustration/quote was produced. The proc fee payable will be confirmed in the illustration which is being progressed.	
Product Type	Commission Structure
Affordable Housing (HMF, Remortgage & FTB)	0.39%, £750 minimum, no maximum
First Time Buyer	0.39%, no minimum or maximum
Homemover & Remortgage	0.36%, no minimum or maximum
Further Advance	0.36%, £300 minimum, no maximum
Product Transfer	0.27%, no minimum or maximum

Birmingham Midshires Procurement Fee Terms for Legal & General Mortgage Club	
The below proc fee structures will take effect from 5th January 2026. For existing pipeline cases the previous proc fee commission structures may still apply, this will depend on when the illustration/quote was produced. The proc fee payable will be confirmed in the illustration which is being progressed.	
Product Type	Commission Structure
Ltd Company Purchase & Remortgage	0.54%, no minimum or maximum
Homemover & Remortgage	0.46%, no minimum or maximum
Further Advance	0.46%, £300 minimum, no maximum
Product Transfer	0.37% no minimum or maximum
Ltd Company Further Advance and Product Transfer	The commission rates applicable to further advances and product transfers will be confirmed once these options become available

Scottish Widows Procurement Fee Terms for Legal & General Mortgage Club	
The below proc fee structures will take effect from 5th January 2026. For existing pipeline cases the previous proc fee commission structures may still apply, this will depend on when the illustration/quote was produced. The proc fee payable will be confirmed in the illustration which is being progressed.	
Product Type	Commission Structure
Further Advance	0.36%, £300 minimum, no maximum
Porting	0.36%, no minimum or maximum
Product Transfer	0.27%, no minimum or maximum

Proc Fee Payment Route

Please do NOT select PMS when applying for a mortgage. Please always select L&G Mortgage Cub, as we always have. (For your information, PMS are our protection service provider – Zenith PMS.)



Introducing LeadGEN

On 10th November 2025 we kicked off the first LeadGEN Introduction to Local Legends session, and the momentum since then has been fantastic. If you missed the live session, you can catch up anytime by watching it here:

<https://knowledgehub.website/10-11-2025-leadgen-introduction-to-local-legends/>

A core part of that session was taking an honest look at your current online presence. This means reviewing your website plus every social media platform you use, and then recording the results on the LeadGEN Social Media Scorecard. If you haven't done this yet, download it here:

<https://knowledgehub.website/wp-content/uploads/2025/11/Social-Media-Scorecard.pdf>

The scorecard gives us two scores
Score 1 (now) and Score 2 (at the end).

My promise to you is simple. Improve your score to what is genuinely possible and you will create more leads, attract more visibility, and become far more present within your local community.

The LeadGEN formula to online success is Visibility + Trust + Engagement = Leads

The uptake on the course has been excellent and it is brilliant seeing so many advisers take control of their online first impression. If you haven't enrolled yet, it's absolutely not too late. Join the journey here:

https://www.surveymonkey.com/r/webpage_audit

5th December – The Power of Engagement

I will be sharing top tips to help you with your online success.

On Friday I shared a killer tip that every adviser using social media should take seriously. Engagement. Social media is not about likes. Likes are fine, but they matter far less than people think, and often slip into vanity metrics.

What matters is engagement!

Engagement means that when somebody interacts with your post in any way, you engage back. You thank them, you open a simple conversation and you treat the interaction exactly the way you would face to face.

It's an opportunity to show your personality and open a conversation.

Recently I posted about property prices in a local housing group and received just two likes. Instead of ignoring them, I replied to both people by tagging them and thanked them. You will see that I also asked an open question to establish a connection and make new contacts. Mark and I have never spoken but his response opened the door to a DM (direct message) which predictably asked if he took a 5 year fixed mortgage as this must be due for renewal.

That is the power of engagement.



Looking Ahead to 2026

I am genuinely excited about what we can build together next year. We will be diving deeper into serious lead generation, exploring the opportunities in paid advertising and continuing to strengthen your visibility and engagement.

The goal is simple. To turn every one of you into a genuine Local Legend your area.

If you have any questions, I am always around, and will be on every Monday Zoom session at 4pm.

Mark

performance

Mortgages – Adviser League Table for November 2025

Congratulations to both **Pratima Gurung** for topping our mortgage table.

<u>Adviser</u>	<u>Cases</u>
Pratima Gurung	37
Dan Fletcher	23
Jonathan Peachey	23
Phil Smith	23
Joanne Pope	21
Samita Rai	21
Unika Rai	21
Jack Savory	19
Carl Thorne	18
Rob Chart	17
Paul Gent	17
Andy Poustie	17
Emily Chattaway	17
Jack Humphries	17
Cathy Rafferty	16
Joe Maskell	15
Paul Ripley	15
Richard Lucy	15
Amit Swar	14
Claire Lipscomb	13
Chris Williams	12
Smriti Pun	12
Joe White	12
Phil James	11
Jim Maye	11
Colin Mackay	10
Ellis Featherbe	10
Graham Morris	10
Matt Stephens	10
Kate Joyice	10

Protection (protection and GI combined) – Adviser League Table for November 2025

Congratulations to **Paul Gent** for topping the protection table in November.

<u>Adviser</u>	<u>Cases</u>
Paul Gent	38
Rob Chart	25
Clare Mann	21
Andy Poustie	19
Richard Lucy	14
Jane Hutchinson	10

Congratulations to everyone who has featured on last month's league tables

Should anyone feel their applications are not being calculated properly, please speak to your Sales Manager as it might mean those cases you have submitted to a lender or insurer have not been recorded as such on Acre yet and we can show you how to fix that.



Well done to the following advisers who have all submitted million-pound cases this year. Lots of new entries this month so congratulations to all. Cases added in the last month are shown in [blue](#).

Mortgage cases

Paul Goodey	£4,810,906
Paul Goodey	£3,881,250
Romi Pal	£3,207,525
Paul Goodey	£2,544,768
Chris Williams	£2,377,875
Paul Goodey	£2,306,000
Paul Goodey	£2,131,737
Jonathan Peachey	£2,028,083
Wilma Scott	£1,762,500
Paul Goodey	£1,742,815
Paul Goodey	£1,629,776
Oliver Cunningham	£1,510,450
Paul Goodey	£1,500,000
Paul Ripley	£1,462,000
Joanne Pope	£1,454,540
Victoria Worthington	£1,410,000
Ellis Featherbe	£1,400,000
Romi Pal	£1,385,000
Phoebe Wight	£1,380,000
Ellis Featherbe	£1,370,000
Richard Lucy	£1,354,870

Carrie Millin	£1,335,897
Victoria Wescott	£1,300,074
Paul Goodey	£1,300,000
Cathy Rafferty	£1,291,980
Wilma Scott	£1,268,688
Trevor Farley	£1,237,393
Rob Chart	£1,234,503
Phil Smith	£1,218,451
Mike Smurthwaite	£1,208,503
Ellis Featherbe	£1,207,000
Paul Goodey	£1,207,000
Jonathon Peachey	£1,200,000
Marion Hunnisett	£1,125,000
Emily Chattaway	£1,170,000
Cathy Rafferty	£1,150,000
Richard Lucy	£1,140,000
Phoebe Wight	£1,105,000
Joanne Pope	£1,100,000
Joanne Pope	£1,083,660
Paul Goodey	£1,072,000
Claire Lipscomb	£1,067,698
Paul Goodey	£1,059,549
Peter Stickley	£1,051,495
Cathy Rafferty	£1,020,000
Paul Goodey	£1,015,521
Jim Maye	£1,014,681
Karen Mills	£1,006,820
Joanne Pope	£1,005,699
Carrie Millin	£1,003,373
Paul Goodey	£1,001,054
Joanne Pope	£1,000,000
Lee Harper	£1,000,000

[Protection cases](#)

Dave Relfe	Exec IPB £3,838,800
Dave Relfe	Exec IPB £3,729,120
Wilma Scott	Life £3,526,998
Paul Gent	Life £2,400,000
Paul Gent	RLP £2,400,000
Victoria Wescott	Life £2,352,000
Paul Gent	IPB £2,339,073
Simon Maskell	Life £1,881,000
Paul Gent	Exec IPB £1,863,948
Simon Maskell	IPB £1,840,000
Lorraine Smith	Life £1,560,790
Ellis Featherbe	Life £1,500,000
Paul Gent	Life £1,400,000
Paul Gent	Life £1,400,000
Paul Gent	Exec IPB £1,240,320
Paul Gent	Exec IPB £1,164,801
Paul Gent	IPB £1,128,204

Richard Lucy	Life £1,000,000
Dave Relfe	RLP £1,000,000
Dave Relfe	RLP £1,000,000
Paul Gent	Life £1,000,000
Paul Gent	Life £1,000,000
Clare Mann	RLP £1,000,000
Clare Mann	RLP £1,000,000

As with the mortgage and protection figures if you feel an application you have made should be referenced here, please speak to your sales manager to confirm if it is showing on Acre correctly.



FPG Anniversaries

So far in 2025 we have seen some very significant milestones reached in terms of service within the Finance Planning Group especially as this is the 25th year of The Finance Planning Group. A big thank you to everyone listed below for your hard work and dedication for however long you've been with us.

- Scott Sutton – 21 years
- Richard Hamley – 9 years
- Simon Maskell – 5 years
- Oliver Cunningham - 4 years
- Beata Kiss – 2 years
- Kim Dock – 2 years
- Susan Gurung – 1 year

I have been compiling these dates from several sources and have tried to be as accurate as possible but apologies in advance if anybody has been missed from this list that should have been recognised for a work anniversary please let me know so I can rectify it.

Upcoming Birthdays

Happy Birthday to everybody celebrating in December.

- Beata Kiss
- Dan Grant
- David Riley
- Jack Savory
- Jim Maye
- Lokesh Gurung
- Piers Aspinall
- Pratima Gurung
- Rob Chart
- Surakshya Rai

miscellaneous

Know Someone Who'd Make a Great Adviser?

FPG are always looking to find new people to join our team, and we know the best people to help grow our network are those already part of it. That's why we're introducing a scheme inviting you to recommend someone you know who'd make a great Mortgage & Protection Adviser. As someone who already shares our values and understands what it means to be part of the FPG network, your referrals are incredibly valuable. As a thank you, you'll receive £500 when your referral signs up, and a further £500 when they achieve competent adviser status. We believe FPG are in a great place to support advisers of nearly any experience in their careers and hopefully as someone already part of the network you would agree, if you have anyone you think might be suitable, please don't hesitate to speak to your Sales Manager.

November Zoom sessions

Here are the details of the Zoom sessions FPG hosted in November and the links to re-watch them. All of the below are good for CPD.

07/11/2025 - Winter Workshop 1 – Unlocking Sales Behaviours That Drive Results - <https://knowledgehub.website/7-11-2025-winter-workshop-1-unlocking-sales-behaviours-that-drive-results/>

10/11/2025 – LEADGEN Introduction to Local Legends – Part one of a practical course lead by Mark Ninnim to get more leads - <https://knowledgehub.website/10-11-2025-leadgen-introduction-to-local-legends/>

14/11/2025 - Winter Workshop 2 Exposing the Realities That Make Income Protection - <https://knowledgehub.website/winter-workshop-2-exposing-the-realities-that-make-income-protection/>

21/11/2025 - Winter Workshop 3 – Unlocking the Power of Trusts and Wills in Client Conversations - <https://knowledgehub.website/winter-workshop-3-unlocking-the-power-of-trusts-and-wills-in-client-conversations/>